

# Vertigo



*Wellington Section Photo Competition*

*Winning Photo - Alpine General and Overall People's  
Choice*

*Fine with light winds the start of a great weekend at  
Mt Ruapehu - photo by Iain Burgon*

# Section News

**Section nights are held on the first Wednesday of each month in the back room at the Southern Cross on Abel Smith Street – please note that the exception to this is the October section night which will take place on the Thursday 13 October.**

## Section Nights

Peter Laurenson and Nigel Roberts, our annual photo comp judges, took us through this year's competition entries at our September section night. As always this provided valuable insights into the elements that make a great photo. Peter and Nigel took us through the photos submitted in each category where the quality of the photos from lowest to highest scoring was obvious. A lot of time and effort goes into the judging and then presenting of the photo comp so huge thanks to Peter and Nigel. The winning photos are included in this edition of Vertigo.

### **October section night – Thursday 13 October, 6pm**

At our October section night we'll be showing some movies and we'll cover off our AGM during the intermission. Feel free to bring friends and family to the section night – I'm sure the movies will be of great interest. More details on the AGM are in the following section of the newsletter.

### **November section night – Wednesday 2 November, 6pm**

We've scored a coup for our November section night and have Lou Sanson of Director General of DOC (and previous CEO of Antarctica NZ) coming and presenting to us. Lou's presentation at the recent Sustainable Summits conference was well received and we're fortunate to have him come along and talk to us about the sustainability challenges for conservation leaders, from Antarctica to the Southern Alps.

**Please don't forget the koha for section night – there'll be an ice bucket at the entry door for that purpose. 😊**

For quick access to the section's page on the NZAC website, scan the below QR code.



## Chair's Report

So much for the ski season. Great spring skiing according to the commercial fields. AKA, lumpy ice in the morning and soft wet slush in the afternoon. Another month has flown by. The days are longer and the scent of alpine passes is in the air, along with bucket loads of rain if you've been in Wellington recently.

On the plus side Reel Rock 11 at the Paramount the other night was awesome! Feedback from those who attended was overwhelmingly positive and the films shown were deemed to be even better than last year. Summer Rock will be gearing up shortly for those of you who are desperate to get your hands on a belay device or have another go at that boulder problem you just couldn't solve last year.

With our AGM coming up in October we are now taking nominations for the 2017 committee. If you want to have more influence over the workings and direction of the section, this is your opportunity to do so. As usual, all positions are open and we are particularly keen to encourage younger members. In fact, there are two positions available to young members to attend the national NZAC AGM as observers in Christchurch this year – expenses paid. Other benefits for our section committee members include discounted gear, support for skill development, outdoor first aid training and other courses. Please email all nominations to [wellington@alpineclub.org.nz](mailto:wellington@alpineclub.org.nz)

Recently a four day back country avalanche course was run for instructors. Unfortunately, I wasn't able to attend but, according to those that did, this was an exceptionally good course and a must for any aspiring instructors. There will be a write up on the course in next month's Vertigo.

I hope to see you at the next section night. Note the change in date to the second Thursday – we couldn't get the Wednesday as Southern Cross had let the room for another event.

There have been a few complaints about music drowning out speakers at our section nights. If anyone knows of a better location for our section nights please get in touch. Considerations are : ability to walk there from the CBD, availability of parking, space for up to 70 people as well as the ability to get a drink and a feed.

That's it from me this month.

If you have any comments on what you liked or didn't like send an email to [wellington@alpineclub.org.nz](mailto:wellington@alpineclub.org.nz) or tweet us @NZACWellington or post a message on our facebook page [www.facebook.com/nzacwellington](http://www.facebook.com/nzacwellington).

Finally: *"Ever Tried, Ever Failed. No Matter. Try Again. Fail Again. Fail Better."* Samuel Beckett  
Simon - Chair: NZAC Wellington

## Notice of Wellington Section of the NZ Alpine Club AGM 2016

The AGM for the Wellington Section of the NZ Alpine Club will take place during our section night on **Thursday 13 October 2016** at the Southern Cross Hotel on Abel Smith Street, Wellington. We're showing some movies from 6pm at this section night and the AGM will take place during intermission.

You are invite to nominate yourself or others for the following committee positions:

- Chair
- Treasurer
- Secretary
- Section night coordinator
- Club liaison
- Social media coordinator
- Trip coordinator
- Gear custodian
- Event coordinator (s)
- Summer Rock director
- Winter course director
- General committee members

Please forward your nominations to [wellington@alpineclub.org.nz](mailto:wellington@alpineclub.org.nz)

The committee meets once a month. Dates and location of the meetings will be selected to enable all committee members to attend in person.

Looking forward to a great turnout on the 13 October – we'll also be showing movies before and after the AGM so come along, grab a drink and a bite to eat from the bar.

### Gear Hire

Don't forget the section has gear for hire : avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, helmets, crampons, probes and PLBs. If you're keen to hire some gear please fill in the form [here](#). Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on its return.

# Wellington Section Photo Competition Results

Huge thanks go to our generous sponsors for providing prizes :

- Bivouac Outdoors provided a Black Diamond head-torch, water purifier, an Ultra-sil Dry daypack, gift card.
- Photo Warehouse provided a mono-pod walking stick
- Hangdog, Lower Hutt provided a number of climbing passes
- NZAC provided a free annual membership
- Water purifier

Peter Laurenson and Nigel Roberts put in the hard yards working through the entries and scoring them to provide us with the following winning photos.

## **Alpine General and Overall People's Choice**

Photographs that display mountain landscapes. Images should be strongly composed with great light. Judges looked at technical excellence, colour, tone and detail along with the image's subject and composition.



Fine with light winds the start of a great weekend at Mt Ruapehu - by Iain Burgon

**Comments from the judges :** A striking rendition of such a well-known aspect of Ruapehu. Great use of light and reflection, well suited to this panoramic format. The exposure has successfully retained all the detail in the snow and tussock.

## Alpine Activity

Photographs where the main subject is people engaging in activity in the alpine environment (e.g. climbing, skiing, tramping, camping). Emphasis on careful composition and 'capturing the moment'.



Joel Faubert shuts his eyes to protect them from the spray from the impact of his ice tool on WI4/5 Left Side of the Lower Weeping Wall, Icefields Parkway, Jasper National Park, Canada (Weeping Wall, January 23, 2016) – by Derek Cheng

**Comments from the judges :** Captures one of those typical ice climbing situations in a very personal way - it's all about the climber. Timing is perfect, catching the maximum ice spray. Lovely composition in terms of use of depth of field to blur the belayer but capture lots of ice texture. Very alpine.



## Alpine Nature

Photographs of natural subjects in the mountain environment, where the emphasis is on artistic rendition. Subjects may include geological features, plants (or parts of plants), animals, water, snow and ice formations etc.



Lattice of cracks in the ice surface of Lake Baikal – by Katja Riedel

**Comments from the judges :** Immediate impact. Nice balance and exposure. Plenty of contrast but no loss of detail.

## Rock Climbing

Photographs of rock climbing and bouldering that have strong visual impact and creative composition.



Having overcome a splitter finger crack, Emily Matherly doesn't hesitate and she throws for a chalked hold on Extra Lean, 5.12a (24), at Second Meat Wall, Indian Creek (Utah, USA, April 2016) – by Derek Cheng

**Comments from the judges :** A real “out there” feel, putting you into the climber’s shoes. Great freeze of a move. Nice use of depth of field.



## Mountain and Climbing Culture

Portray the climbing life and places and people encountered by climbers. Entries might include travel photography (as long as it's strongly related to climbing) or documentary-style images, covering any aspect of climbing.



Big wall climbers organise massive haul bags on the iconic El Cap Spire, Salathe Wall, El Capitan, while two climbers laze in their portaledge in the Alcove, a pitch further below (Yosemite, USA, June 2016) – by Derek Cheng.

**Comments from the judges :** Lovely composition and exposure, accentuating the lofty location. Climbers look like they're having a blast.



## Humour

Whatever gets you a laugh.



Michael ninja kicks as Hannah takes evasive action on El Cap Spire, halfway up the Salathe Wall (Yosemite, USA, June 2016) – by Derek Cheng

**Comments from the judges :** Technically strong exposure and composition. Dramatic location, striking pose, with semi deadpan expression is definitely humorous.

## Kids

Alpine / climbing-related photos taken by kids.



Clusters, Lobuje, Khumbu, Nepal - Age 15, Dec 2015 – by Edwin Laurenson

**Comments from the judge** (Nigel scored this category) : Striking image. Creative composition well executed in terms of depth of field, sharpness.

# Upcoming Trips, Courses and Events

## Wellington Section Trips

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs are covered by the section. If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or know more email us on [wellington@alpineclub.org.nz](mailto:wellington@alpineclub.org.nz).

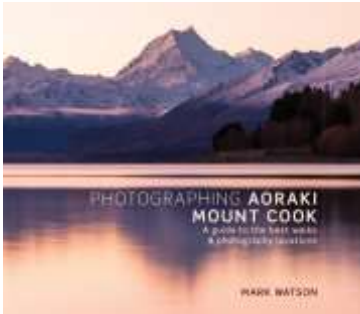
Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the committee can help with advertising / logistics.

| When?          | Where?                                                  |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 8-9 October    | Tapuae-o-Uenuku – led by Ian Barnes                     |
| Labour Weekend | Rock-climbing trip to Payne's Ford - led by Eric Duggan |
| Labour Weekend | Mt Hopeless, Nelson Lakes – led by Simon Williamson     |
| November       | Mt Aspiring – led by Simon Williamson                   |

# Notices

## Great deals on books – discounts available for NZAC members

Photographing Aoraki Mt Cook by Mark Watson - special member discounted price of \$28 + p&p (rrp \$35).



Purchase via the NZAC online shop:

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/photographing-aoraki-mount-cook/>

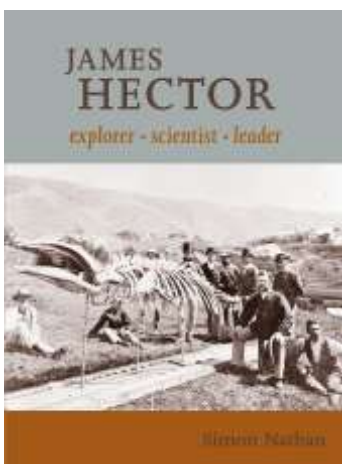
So Far So Good: a three-month traverse of the Southern Alps by Craig Potton - special member discounted price of \$40 + p&p (rrp \$49.99).



Purchase via the NZAC online shop:

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/so-far-so-good/>

James Hector : explorer, scientist; leader by Simon Nathan



20% off RRP by quoting Discount Code (viewable when logged in)  
Free Freight within New Zealand

Dates available:

13 June – 30 September 2016

<http://www.pottonandburton.co.nz/store/james-hector>



## Expedition Grant – New Routes on Never Seen Tower, India

The Expedition Fund Committee have granted \$2000 for an expedition to find new routes on Never Seen Tower (5750m), Miyar Valley, Himachal Pradesh, India. The Expedition Team consists of Llewellyn Murdoch, Allison Swintz, Nick Cradock and David Shotwell.



<https://alpineclub.org.nz/expedition-grant-new-routes-on-never-seen-tower-india/>

## Book launch – Only Two for Everest

Otago University Press warmly invites you to celebrate the publication of *Only Two for Everest: How a first ascent by Riddiford and Cotter changed climbing history*, by Lyn McKinnon.

**When:** 5.30pm, Wednesday 5 October 2016

**Where:** Prefab, 14 Jessie Street, Te Aro, Wellington

**RSVP:** [publicity@otago.ac.nz](mailto:publicity@otago.ac.nz) by Monday 3 October, making it clear you will be attending the Wellington launch

## Thanks to Cactus Outdoor!



A special thank you to Cactus Outdoor for continuing their support of the NZAC Expedition Fund via an extra donation raised from a percentage of online sales and donated annually. A reminder too, that members receive 10% off their purchase price when buying from this outdoor equipment and clothing specialist.

**Thanks to Split'n2!**



A special thank you to Split'n2 and Richard Harcourt for continuing their support of the NZAC Club Hut Fund via an extra donation raised from a percentage of online sales and donated annually. A reminder too, that members receive 10% off their purchase price when buying from this splitboard and backcountry equipment specialist.

## **Nominations for NZAC Volunteer of the Year Award**



Nominations are being called for this year's NZAC Volunteer of the Year Award. Nominations must be submitted to your section Chairperson who will sign-off and return them to the office to be collated for judging.

The winner receives a certificate of appreciation and has their name engraved on the award pictured, which they hold until the following year. We have a cut-off for nominations of 3 October and presentation will be either at the November AGM, or made by a club representative should the winner not be available to attend.

See <https://alpineclub.org.nz/volunteer-of-the-year-award/> for more details on how to complete your nomination and then send your nomination to Simon at [crisisresponse@gmail.com](mailto:crisisresponse@gmail.com) or Eric at [ericduggan@gmail.com](mailto:ericduggan@gmail.com).

Past VOTY winners:

|      |                |
|------|----------------|
| 2008 | John Salisbury |
| 2009 | Clayton Garbes |
| 2010 | Chris Munro    |
| 2011 | Grant Piper    |
| 2012 | Richard Knott  |
| 2013 | Lindsay Main   |
| 2014 | Terry Cole     |
| 2015 | Al Walker      |

## Rolleston Memorial

In Memory of John Harrison and the 4 young climbers, two from the UK and 2 young Alpine Club members, who were lost in a shocking storm on Mt Rolleston 50 years ago, in June 1966, a memorial has been made. The memorial is in the form of a 'Boot' that has been cast by Sam Mahon, along with a plaque in remembrance of all who were lost.



The organiser, Anne McGregor, is pleased to announce that the Department of Conservation (DOC) has now agreed to the placement of this memorial on Arthur's Pass National Park land. It is to be installed on a rock behind the chapel close to the Jim Glasgow Memorial Bridge, itself carefully crafted by the late Hans Bonny.

At present, the boot and plaque are in The DOC Headquarters at the Pass with a Memorial Wall alongside a memorial wall for the public to read the newspaper article of this event as recorded at the time. The cost to install the memorial comes to \$3500 and funds are being raised by donation. This notice is to both raise awareness of the memorial placement, which is expected before the end of the year, and to ask for donations towards the installation cost. If you would like to make a donation, please email [margaret@alpineclub.org.nz](mailto:margaret@alpineclub.org.nz) and she will pass on the organiser's bank account details where these can be deposited. If you would rather send a cheque, please make payable to Anne McGregor and not NZAC. They can be sent C/- NZAC, PO Box 786, Christchurch 8140.

## NZAC member discounted rates at DOC huts

A reminder to members that you will need to have your ACTIVE NZAC membership card with you when paying hut fees at DOC offices to obtain discounted rates. They have no way to check your membership is active and will likely insist on seeing your card to give you member rates. NZAC won't be able to refund overpayments, so it is important to have your member card on you at the time of payment.

## **NZAC 2017 Climbing Camp**

The Otago Section will be hosting the 2017 climbing camp that will be from Saturday 4th to Saturday 11th February. The Camp will be based at the Top Forks Hut in the Wilkin Valley. As it is a 12 hour walk into the Top Forks hut it is proposed that people attending the camp travel by helicopter from Makarora.

Top Forks hut is in a stunning alpine environment and there are several peaks within striking distance of the hut, many of them grade 1 climbs. Campers are expected to be self-contained with their own tent, cooking equipment, fuel and food. We will have access to the hut but not exclusive use. We will be providing some basic communal facilities such as a tarp shelter, dish-washing facilities, toilet tent, thermos and a mountain radio.

We will limit the number of people attending the camp to 40 so early registration is recommended. You can obtain additional information and a registration form from the NZAC website. There will be a modest registration fee and you are expected to pay for your helicopter or jet boat travel to and from the camp. Budget on \$170 each way to/from Top Forks for the helicopter or \$110 each way for jet boat access via Kerin Forks Hut. Note: Top Forks is still a 6 hr walk from Kerin Forks. An option is to fly in and jet boat out.

The camp is suitable for climbers of all levels of experience but you must be an Alpine club member to attend. If you do not have a climbing partner at the camp we will arrange for you to team up with other climbers.

If you require additional information contact Keith Moffat Ph 03 473-8903 Mob 0276644037 or e-mail [Moffat.k172@gmail.com](mailto:Moffat.k172@gmail.com)



# Wellington Section 2016 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at [wellington@alpineclub.org.nz](mailto:wellington@alpineclub.org.nz)

| Position                   | Name             | Contact       |
|----------------------------|------------------|---------------|
| Chairperson                | Simon Williamson | 021 054 7684  |
| Co Chair                   | Eric Duggan      | 021 350 161   |
| Treasurer                  | Mark Leslie      | 027 338 4458  |
| Secretary & Vertigo editor | Carolyn Ellis    | 021 574 287   |
| Patron                     | John Nankervis   |               |
| Other Committee Members    | Aviette Musin    | 021 0299 5390 |
|                            | Sharron Came     |               |
|                            | Gina Butson      |               |
|                            | Elisha Watson    |               |
|                            |                  |               |
| Rock Drill Overseer        | Jeremy Tries     | 027 55 55 893 |

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Twitter @NZACWellington



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\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012

New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through  
better climbing

\* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



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www.hangdog.co.nz

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Ocelot  
\$115



MXC 820  
\$230



Makalu  
\$255



Caiman  
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